

SOP & Operations Handbook

Standard Operating Procedures for every repeatable task in your agency.

ABOUT THIS HANDBOOK

Your Agency Operations Bible

SOPs (Standard Operating Procedures) are the backbone of a scalable agency. Without them, you are always the bottleneck. With them, anyone on your team can execute at your standard — without you.

This handbook contains 10 core SOPs covering every repeatable task in a Social Media Management agency. Each SOP includes a purpose statement, step-by-step process, quality checklist, and a notes field to customize for your workflow.

HOW TO USE THIS HANDBOOK

1. Read through each SOP fully before customizing
2. Fill in the blank fields with your own tools, timelines, and standards
3. Share relevant SOPs with your team members
4. Review and update SOPs every quarter as your agency evolves
5. Store in your Notion workspace (template included in this bundle)

WHAT'S INSIDE

SOP 01 — Client Onboarding	Page 2
SOP 02 — Content Creation Workflow	Page 3
SOP 03 — Content Approval Process	Page 4
SOP 04 — Monthly Reporting	Page 5

SOP 05 — Community Management	Page 6
SOP 06 — New Hire Onboarding	Page 7
SOP 07 — Client Offboarding	Page 8
SOP 08 — Crisis Management	Page 9
SOP 09 — Invoice & Payment Collection	Page 10
SOP 10 — Weekly Agency Review	Page 11
SOP Template (blank)	Page 12

SOP 01

Client Onboarding

PURPOSE: Ensure every new client receives a consistent, professional onboarding experience that sets clear expectations, collects all necessary assets, and starts the relationship on a strong foundation.

TRIGGER: Contract signed + deposit received

OWNER: Account Manager / Founder

TIMELINE: Complete within 5 business days of contract signing

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1

Send Welcome Email (Day 0 — same day contract signed)

Use the Welcome Email template from this bundle. Include: welcome message, onboarding checklist link, meeting booking link, and expected first deliverable date.

2

Book Onboarding Call (Day 1–2)

60-minute onboarding call. Agenda: introductions → brand voice deep-dive → content pillars → platform strategy → access handover → Q&A.; Record the call.

3

Send Brand Questionnaire (Day 1)

Send the Brand Questionnaire (File 2.2 in this bundle) via email or Google Form. Due: 48 hours before the onboarding call.

4

Collect All Access & Assets (Day 2–3)

Social media account access (via Business Manager or direct login), brand kit (logo, colors, fonts), product photos, past content (if any), competitor list.

5

Conduct Brand Audit (Day 3–4)

Review existing social media presence: profile optimization, content performance, audience demographics. Document findings in the Brand Audit Template (File 2.3).

6

Deliver Month 1 Strategy (Day 4–5)

Send the Month 1 Content Strategy document. Include: platform focus, content pillars, posting frequency, tone of voice, KPIs to track. Get written approval.

7

Create Client Folder & Set Up Tools (Day 5)

Create shared Google Drive folder. Set up content calendar in scheduling tool. Add client to CRM (Notion template in this bundle). Add to invoicing system.

QUALITY CHECKLIST

Welcome email sent	_____	_____	_____
Onboarding call completed + recorded	_____	_____	_____
Brand questionnaire received	_____	_____	_____
All social access collected	_____	_____	_____
Brand audit completed	_____	_____	_____
Month 1 strategy approved	_____	_____	_____
Client folder created	_____	_____	_____
Client added to CRM	_____	_____	_____
First invoice sent	_____	_____	_____

Client Name: _____

Contract Start Date: _____

Onboarding Call Date: _____

Strategy Approval Date: _____

My Notes: _____

My Notes (cont.): _____

Content Creation Workflow

PURPOSE: Produce high-quality, on-brand social media content efficiently every month by following a structured creation, review, and scheduling process.

TRIGGER: First of each month (or 10 days before the new content period)

WEEKLY CONTENT PRODUCTION SCHEDULE

Monday	Pull last week's performance data + insights	Analyst	Platform Analytics
Monday	Brief the content creator on week's themes	Manager	Slack / Notion
Tuesday	Write captions + copy for all posts	Copywriter	Notion / Docs
Tuesday	Design graphics and/or edit video content	Designer	Canva / CapCut
Wednesday	Internal quality review — check brand alignment	Manager	Drive
Wednesday	Send to client for approval (if required)	Manager	Email / Portal
Thursday	Incorporate feedback + finalize content	Creator	Canva / Docs
Thursday	Schedule all approved content	Scheduler	Later / Buffer
Friday	Confirm all posts scheduled correctly	Manager	Scheduling Tool

CONTENT QUALITY STANDARDS

Before Publishing — Every Post Must Pass This Checklist
✓ Caption reviewed for grammar, spelling, and brand voice
✓ Hashtags researched — mix of niche, medium, and broad tags (20–30 max on IG)
✓ Visual is correctly sized for the platform (IG 1080×1080 / 1080×1920, LinkedIn 1200×628)

- ✓ Call-to-action (CTA) is clear and matches the post goal
- ✓ Post time is optimized for the client's audience (check analytics)
- ✓ No competitor brand names mentioned unintentionally
- ✓ Links tested (for stories, link-in-bio, or LinkedIn posts)
- ✓ Client has approved (if approval is required per contract)
- ✓ Post logged in the Content Calendar (Google Sheet in this bundle)

Tools I Use for Captions:

Tools I Use for Design:

Scheduling Tool:

Client Approval Tool:

Monthly Performance Reporting

PURPOSE: Deliver professional, data-driven monthly reports to every client that demonstrate ROI, show growth, and reinforce the value of the retainer.

TRIGGER: 28th of each month (deliver report by the 3rd of following month)

STEP-BY-STEP REPORTING PROCESS

1	Pull Platform Data (28th–30th) Export metrics from each platform: Instagram Insights, Facebook Analytics, LinkedIn Analytics, TikTok Analytics. Save as CSV or screenshot for the report period.
2	Calculate KPIs (30th–31st) Enter data into the KPI Dashboard Google Sheet (included in this bundle). Calculate: follower growth %, engagement rate %, reach, impressions, top posts, website clicks.
3	Write Report Narrative (1st–2nd) Write the story behind the numbers: What worked well? What underperformed and why? What are the key insights for next month? Use plain English — no jargon.
4	Add Recommendations (2nd) Include 3–5 specific, actionable recommendations for the next month based on the data. This is what separates good reports from great ones.
5	Send Report (by 3rd) Email the PDF report or share the Notion Client Portal link. Subject line: [Client Name] — [Month] Social Media Performance Report
6	Book Review Call (optional but recommended) Offer a 30-minute report walkthrough call for Growth/Agency tier clients. This is also your upsell opportunity.

REPORT STRUCTURE TEMPLATE

Executive Summary	3–5 key wins + 1 challenge in plain English	1 paragraph

KPI Dashboard	All key metrics vs. last month + vs. target	1 table
Platform Breakdown	Instagram / LinkedIn / TikTok results separately	1 page
Top Content	3 best-performing posts with screenshots + insights	Half page
Audience Insights	Follower demographics, growth, peak times	Half page
Key Learnings	What data tells us about the audience	3–5 bullets
Next Month Plan	Strategy adjustments based on this month's data	3–5 bullets
Recommendations	3–5 specific, actionable next steps	Bullet list

My Report Template Tool:

Report Delivery Method:

Review Call Platform:

My Reporting Day Each Month:

Social Media Crisis Management

PURPOSE: Respond swiftly and professionally to any social media crisis on behalf of a client — whether it's a PR issue, viral negative comment, account hack, or accidental post — to protect the client's brand and your agency's reputation.

TRIGGER: Any of the following: negative viral post, mass complaint, account security breach, accidental wrong post, client public controversy

CRISIS RESPONSE LEVELS

■ Level 1	Negative comment / small complaint	Within 4 hours	Community Manager
■ Level 2	Multiple complaints / minor PR issue	Within 2 hours	Account Manager
■ Level 3	Viral negative / account hack / major PR	Within 30 min	Founder + Client

LEVEL 3 CRISIS RESPONSE PROTOCOL

1	STOP — Pause all scheduled content immediately Log into the scheduling tool and pause all upcoming posts until the crisis is resolved. Do not publish anything during a crisis.
2	NOTIFY — Alert the client within 15 minutes Call the client directly. Do not just email. Explain the situation clearly, state what action you are taking, and ask for their input on response strategy.
3	ASSESS — Understand the full scope Screenshot everything. Check all platforms. Read all comments. Identify: is this growing or contained? Who are the main voices? What is the main complaint/narrative?
4	RESPOND — Draft and approve a response Draft a response with the client's approval before publishing. Tone: calm, empathetic, factual. Never defensive, never dismissive. Acknowledge → explain → resolve.

5

MONITOR — Watch closely for 48 hours

Monitor all platforms every 2 hours for 48 hours post-crisis. Report updates to the client every 4 hours until the situation is resolved.

6

DEBRIEF — Document what happened

Within 7 days, write a crisis debrief: what happened, how it escalated, how it was resolved, and what changes to prevent recurrence. Store in client file.

THINGS YOU MUST NEVER DO IN A CRISIS

X Never delete legitimate negative comments — it escalates the situation

X Never argue with commenters, even if they are wrong

X Never respond without client approval on major issues

X Never go silent — acknowledge quickly even if you don't have full answers yet

X Never make promises you cannot keep in a public response

My Crisis Escalation Contact:

Client Emergency Number:

My Platform Pause Process:

My Notes:

Daily Community Management

PURPOSE: Maintain an active, engaged, and growing social media community for every client through consistent, brand-aligned daily engagement.

TRIGGER: Daily — execute during morning and afternoon windows

DAILY ENGAGEMENT CHECKLIST (per client, per platform)

Reply to all comments on posts	✓	✓	10–15
Reply to all DMs / messages	✓	✓	5–10
Like and reply to story mentions / tags	✓	—	5
Engage with 5 posts from followers	✓	—	10
Engage with 5 posts from target hashtags	—	✓	10
Like competitor followers' content (follow strategy)	—	✓	5
Check for brand mentions (manual search or alerts)	✓	—	5
Flag any urgent comments/DMs for client	✓	✓	2

COMMENT RESPONSE TEMPLATES

Generic Positive Comment Response Templates (customize to brand voice)
Positive comment: "Thank you so much! ■ We love hearing this. [add relevant detail]"
Product question: "Great question! [Answer]. Feel free to DM us for more details ■"
Complaint (public): "We're sorry to hear this. Please DM us directly so we can resolve this for you right away."
Tag/mention: "Thanks for the tag, [name]! ■ So glad you [mentioned what they shared]."

Emoji-only comment: Reply with matching positive energy emoji + short warm response

Tool I Use for DM Management:

Daily Time Budget Per Client (min):

My Morning Engagement Window:

My Afternoon Engagement Window:

SOP BLANK TEMPLATE

Create Your Own SOP

Use this blank template to document any additional SOP your agency needs. Make a copy and fill it in for each new repeatable process.

SOP Name:	SOP Number:
Department:	Owner (Role):
Trigger (what starts this SOP):	Completion Deadline:
Last Updated:	Version:

PURPOSE STATEMENT

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				

QUALITY CHECKLIST

	■	
	■	
	■	
	■	
	■	

ADDITIONAL NOTES